

TRIS Website Rebuild - Product & Functional Requirements

1. Project Vision

This project is not a redesign of the current website. It is the development of a scalable digital platform that enables travellers to discover, plan and book authentic experiences across Meghalaya while allowing TRIS to manage operations efficiently.

The platform should also be architected to support future mobile applications without requiring significant redevelopment of the core system.

The platform should enable travellers to:

- Discover Meghalaya through authentic experiences and stories.
- Understand the TRIS philosophy and approach to responsible travel.
- Explore curated experiences and journeys.
- Book with minimal back-and-forth communication.
- Build confidence before contacting TRIS.
- Complete as much of the booking journey online as possible.

The platform should enable TRIS to:

- Reduce manual operational work.
- Standardise products and pricing.
- Automate repetitive booking tasks.
- Scale without proportionally increasing manpower.

1.1. Project Scope: The first phase of the platform will include the following modules:

Products

- **Experiences**
Immersive experiences from a few hours to a full day.
- **Curated Journeys**
Thoughtfully designed multi-day journeys across Meghalaya.
- **Small Group Journeys**
Scheduled small-group departures for solo travellers and like-minded explorers.
- **Craft My Journey**
A completely personalised journey, designed around you.

Discover

- Destinations
- Stories / Blog
- Local Crafts & Artisans

Partners

- Partner with Us (Form to express interest)

Business Operations

- Admin CMS
- Booking & Operations Dashboard

- Pricing Engine (** The Pricing Engine shall automate the calculation of selling prices across the platform while allowing TRIS to centrally manage configurable pricing rules.)
- Booking & Availability Management
- Reports & Analytics

Content Management

- *Testimonials*
 - *Photos*
 - *Videos*
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2. Business Goals

The website should achieve the following:

Primary Goals

- ✓ Increase enquiries
 - ✓ Increase direct bookings
 - ✓ Reduce manual WhatsApp conversations
 - ✓ Reduce quotation preparation
 - ✓ Reduce repetitive customer questions
 - ✓ Improve conversion rate
 - ✓ Improve SEO
 - ✓ Increase trust
 - ✓ Showcase TRIS as Meghalaya's experience platform
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3. Brand Positioning

The website must clearly communicate that:

TRIS is NOT

- ✗ A tour operator
- ✗ A package seller
- ✗ A taxi company
- ✗ A hotel booking website

TRIS should be presented as

- ✓ Meghalaya Experience Platform
- ✓ Curator of immersive journeys
- ✓ Community-rooted travel company
- ✓ Local experience specialists
- ✓ Trusted local experts

Every page should reinforce this positioning.

4. Design Principles

Preserve

- Founder story
- The message, the story

- Community-first philosophy & The TRIS Difference
 - Community
 - Authenticity
 - Curation
 - Responsible travel
- Warm tone
- Authentic photography
- Real traveller stories
- Local identity

Improve

- Simpler navigation
- Clear information hierarchy
- Premium visual design
- Responsive mobile experience
- Faster page loading
- Consistent typography
- Better use of white space
- Clear calls to action

5. Primary Navigation

The primary navigation should remain clean and intuitive, allowing visitors to quickly discover experiences, plan their journey, and learn about TRIS.

The main navigation should include:

- Home
- Experiences
- Curated Journeys
- Small Group Journeys
- Craft My Journey
- Destinations
- Stories
- Local Crafts
- Partner with Us
- About
- Contact

Note: The final navigation structure may be refined during the UI/UX design phase, provided the overall information architecture and user experience objectives are maintained. The navigation should also provide clear calls to action for bookings, enquiries, and custom journey requests.

6. Target Audience

- The platform is designed primarily for travellers seeking authentic, meaningful, and well-curated experiences rather than conventional sightseeing tours.

- The primary target audience includes:
 - Domestic and international leisure travellers.
 - Travellers seeking authentic cultural, nature, adventure, and community-based experiences.
 - Travellers who value quality, personalisation, and responsible tourism.
 - Travellers looking for customised itineraries and expert local guidance.
 - The platform should also support secondary user groups, including:
 - Local partners interested in collaborating with TRIS.
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General Development Requirements

The platform should provide a seamless customer experience that allows travellers to:

- Save products to a Wishlist for future reference.
- Add eligible products to their cart.
- Book eligible products through a simple and secure checkout process.
- Submit enquiries for products that require consultation or customisation.
- Review a clear booking summary before confirming a booking or submitting an enquiry.

The website should not be developed as a collection of static pages. Instead, it should be built as a modular, database-driven platform where Experiences, Journeys, Destinations, Stories, Local Crafts & Artisans, and Partner Applications are independent content types that can be managed through the Admin CMS and interconnected where appropriate.

The architecture should be scalable, maintainable, and designed to support future expansion without requiring significant redevelopment. This approach will reduce ongoing maintenance, improve SEO, support business automation, and provide TRIS with the flexibility to introduce new products and features over time.

Phase 0: Information Architecture & UX

Before any UI design or development work begins, the following deliverables should be prepared and submitted for review and approval by TRIS:

1. Complete sitemap (all pages and navigation).
2. User flows for each product (Experiences, Curated Journeys, Small Group Journeys, and Craft My Journey).
3. Low-fidelity wireframes for key pages (Home, Experience Detail, Journey Detail, Craft My Journey, Destination, and other major templates as required).
4. Proposed CMS structure and database schema, including the fields for each content type.
5. Booking and enquiry flow diagrams illustrating the end-to-end customer journey.

Development should commence only after these deliverables have been reviewed and approved by TRIS.

PRODUCT REQUIREMENT DOCUMENT (PRD)

Product 1: Experiences

1. Product Overview

Purpose

Experiences is designed to allow travellers to discover and book immersive local experiences in Meghalaya through a simple, self-service booking process.

Unlike TRIS Curated Journeys, Experiences are standardised products that can be booked online with minimal manual coordination while allowing TRIS to maintain full operational control over pricing, availability and staffing.

Objectives

- Provide a fast and intuitive booking experience.
- Reduce manual quotation and booking coordination.
- Display transparent pricing.
- Allow TRIS to manage operations through a central CMS.
- Build a scalable system that supports new experiences without additional development.

2. Product Principles

The Experiences module should follow these core principles:

- The booking process should be simple and require as few steps as possible.
- Customers should always see real-time availability.
- Pricing should be transparent, while internal calculations remain hidden.
- TRIS should have complete control over availability, staffing, pricing and scheduling through the backend.
- The platform should be scalable, allowing new experiences to be added without requiring code changes.

3. Customer Experience

3.1 Experience Categories: Experiences should be organised into the following categories:

- Adventure
- Nature & Wildlife
- Culture & Heritage
- Food & Local Life
- Wellness
- Creative Experiences

The platform should also support filters such as:

- Family Friendly
- Photography Friendly
- Beginner Friendly
- Rainy Season
- Private Experience

- Half Day / Full Day
- Difficulty Level

3.2 Experience Listing: The listing page should allow travellers to:

- Browse experiences by category
- Filter experiences
- Search by keyword (optional)
- View a summary card showing:
 - Featured image
 - Experience name
 - Duration
 - Starting price
 - Category
 - Primary call-to-action (**Check Availability**)

3.3 Experience Page: Each experience should have a dedicated page containing:

- Hero image or video
- Experience overview
- Why this experience is special (TRIS Story)
- Highlights
- Duration
- Difficulty
- Suitable For
- Best Season
- What's Included
- What to Bring
- Meeting Point
- Image Gallery
- Before You Book
- Reviews
- Frequently Asked Questions

The booking widget should remain easily accessible throughout the page without affecting the storytelling experience.

3.4. Booking Journey

The booking process should be simple, intuitive and require minimal steps.

Step	Customer Action
1	Click Check Availability
2	Select preferred date
3	Select available time slot
4	Select number of guests
5	Add Trusted Local Ride (optional)
6	Enter contact details (Name, Mobile, Email)
7	Review booking summary

Step	Customer Action
8	Reserve booking / Proceed to payment

4. Business Rules

4.1. Booking Rules

- Online booking is available only for dates at least **10 days** in advance.
- Bookings within 10 days should display **Request Booking** instead of instant confirmation.
- Experience availability is controlled through the Availability Calendar.
- Bookings remain tentative until payment is received.
- If payment is not completed within the configured holding period, the reservation expires and the slot becomes available again.
- Closed dates cannot be booked under any circumstances.

4.2. Pricing

The final amount payable for an experience is derived from several configurable components. While the customer should only see the final amount payable, the system should allow TRIS to configure and manage the individual pricing components from the admin panel.

The pricing may consist of:

- Per person experience cost (Adults / Children)
- Staff cost (based on staffing requirements)
- Optional Trusted Local Ride (based on selected vehicle and quantity)
- Operational / Service Fee (Fixed amount or Percentage)
- GST (applicable only on the Operational / Service Fee)

We should be able to introduce if needed:

- Promo codes
- Seasonal discounts
- Group discounts
- Surge pricing
- Membership pricing

Customer View

The booking summary should display only

- Experience Name
- Number of Adults & Children
- Trusted Local Ride (if selected)
- **Total Amount Payable (Inclusive of applicable taxes)**

The individual pricing components should remain visible only within the admin panel.

4.3. Staff Allocation

Each experience has different operational requirements and may require different staff types and staffing ratios. The platform should allow each experience to define its own staffing configuration. For each experience, TRIS should be able to configure:

- **Guest Range**
- **Staff Type**
- **Quantity**
- **Cost per Staff**

Examples of staff types include:

- Guide
- Local Host
- Lead Instructor
- Others

The applicable staffing configuration should be determined based on the selected group size, and the associated staff cost should automatically form part of the final experience price.

5. Experience Management (Admin CMS)

5.1 Experience Information

Administrators should be able to manage:

- Experience Name
- Description
- Images
- Category
- Tags
- Duration
- Difficulty
- Suitable For
- Meeting Point
- Best Season
- What's Included
- What to Bring
- FAQs
- Status / Availability
 - Draft
 - Active
 - Hidden
 - Seasonal
 - Sold Out

5.2. Availability Management

Administrators should be able to manage the availability of each experience by:

- Blocking specific dates
- Blocking recurring weekdays

- Adding local holidays
- Adding festivals or community events
- Adding weather or operational closures
- Marking dates as Sold Out

5.3. Capacity & Schedule

TRIS should be able to configure the following for each experience:

- Minimum Guests
- Maximum Guests
- Maximum Guests per Time Slot
- Maximum Daily Capacity
- Multiple Daily Time Slots
- Experience Duration
- Buffer Time Between Sessions
- Booking Cut-off
- Minimum Advance Booking Period
- Sold Out Dates
- Dates closed

Backend

Administrators can:

- Block dates
- Block recurring weekdays
- Add holidays
- Add festivals
- Add weather closures
- Mark experiences as sold out

5.4. Pricing: Administrators can configure:

- Base Price
- Ride Cost for transport

Product 2 – Curated Journeys

The Curated Journeys module will be based on the existing TRIS offering named as “Customizable packages” in existing website. While the core functionality and content will remain similar, the user flow, navigation, and overall user experience should be redesigned to be simpler, more intuitive, and easier for travellers to explore and enquire about journeys.

The platform should allow the TRIS team to easily create, edit, duplicate, archive and publish journey listings through the Admin CMS without requiring technical assistance.

The journey pages should support:

- itinerary
- highlights
- inclusions
- gallery
- FAQs
- enquiry form

Key Changes from Existing Website

- To add sample photos of the stays varieties
 - To add some name of stays for each Category
 - To change stay category
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Product 3: Small Group Journeys

The Small Group Journeys module will be based on the existing TRIS offering. While the core functionality and content will remain similar, the user flow, navigation, and overall user experience should be redesigned to be simpler, more intuitive, and easier for travellers to discover and join scheduled departures.

Key Changes from Existing Website

- To add sample photos of the stays varieties
 - To add some name of stays for each Category
 - To change stay category
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Product 4: Craft My Journey

The Craft My Journey module will be based on the existing TRIS enquiry form. Travellers should be able to submit a customised travel request by providing details such as their travel dates, interests, preferences, budget, group size, and other relevant information.

While the overall functionality and information captured will remain similar to the existing form, the user flow, interface, and overall experience should be redesigned to be simpler, more intuitive, and easier to complete.

The module should also provide an easy-to-use backend interface that enables the TRIS team to view, manage, and respond to enquiries efficiently.

Content Management Requirements

Wherever applicable, all customer-facing content should be manageable through the Admin CMS. The TRIS team should be able to create, edit, publish, archive, and manage listings without requiring technical assistance. This includes updating text, images, pricing, schedules, availability, itineraries, and other relevant content.

DISCOVER

- Local Crafts & Artisans

The Local Crafts & Artisans page is intended to showcase Meghalaya's traditional crafts, local products, and the artisans who create them. Its purpose is to help travellers discover authentic locally made products and encourage direct engagement with local makers.

This module is **not** intended to function as an e-commerce marketplace. Customers will not be able to purchase products directly through the website. Instead, the page will serve as a curated digital catalogue, providing information about the products, their cultural significance, and where they can be purchased.

The page should allow the TRIS team to easily create, edit, publish, and manage artisan profiles and product showcases through the Admin CMS.

Each listing may include:

- Product photographs & its makers Profile photograph
- Product description
- Artisan or enterprise detail who are selling them
- Story of the artisan or community
- Craft category
- Village or location
- Cultural significance (where applicable)
- Contact details (optional)
- Social media or website links (where available)
- Information on where travellers can purchase the products (e.g., workshop, village, local market, or retail outlet)

The overall design should reflect the TRIS brand by highlighting the people, stories, and cultural heritage behind each craft, rather than presenting the page as an online store.

Partner with Us

Partner with Us form allows local guides, homestays, transport providers, experience providers, artisans, and other tourism stakeholders to submit an application expressing their interest in working with TRIS.

*Submission of the form does **not** constitute approval or onboarding. All applications are reviewed by TRIS, and shortlisted applicants may undergo further evaluation, including service trials or quality assessments, before being formally onboarded as partners.*

Automated Notifications

Automatic emails and WhatsApp messages for:

Booking received

Payment link

Payment confirmation

Booking confirmed

Reminder before travel

Travel documents

Review request after trip

SEO & Performance

The platform should be designed and developed with search engine optimisation, performance, and scalability as core considerations from the outset.

The website should:

- Load quickly across desktop and mobile devices.
- Be fully responsive and mobile-first.
- Follow SEO best practices to maximise discoverability by search engines.
- Allow the TRIS team to manage SEO-related content (such as page titles, descriptions and URLs) through the Admin CMS.
- Support structured content and internal linking to improve search visibility.
- Be designed to achieve strong Core Web Vitals and overall website performance.

The developer should implement appropriate technical SEO practices and performance optimisation techniques as part of the development process.

Filters

For Experiences

Location

Duration

Difficulty

Season

Price

Family Friendly

Adventure

For Journeys

Days

Travel Style

Budget

Season

Difficulty

Family

Luxury

Adventure

Future Enhancements

The platform architecture should be designed to accommodate future enhancements without requiring significant redevelopment. While the following features are not part of the current project scope, they should be considered during the system architecture and database design.

- AI-powered trip recommendations
- Live guide and host availability
- Customer accounts and booking history
- Loyalty programme
- Reviews and ratings
- Gift vouchers
- Referral programme
- Partner Dashboard
- API integrations with third-party platforms
- Customer dashboard